STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-5400
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA GREG LONDON SHERIFF	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **02/09/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES
SUBJECT RIDE ALONG PROGRAM	CROSS REFERENCE G-3310 Road Patrol Uniform G-4300 Sheriff's Office Vehicles G-6200 Authorized Weapons

I. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to provide guidelines for the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Citizen Ride Along Program and ride-alongs by other department members.

II. Policy

It is the general policy of this department that citizens shall **not** be allowed to ride in Sheriff's Office vehicles unless such transportation is directly related to a legitimate provision of public service. The Road Patrol Watch Commanders shall coordinate a Citizen Ride Along Program to accommodate formal requests from the public to observe road patrol activities. Each request shall be considered on a case-by-case basis.

III. Procedure

A. Citizen Requests: Citizens may request to ride with a Sheriff's Department Road Patrol deputy by completing a Ride Along Request Form.

1. The form shall be directed to the appropriate watch commander who, after reviewing it, shall forward it to the Patrol Commander and the Sheriff. The following regulations shall apply to all citizen ride-alongs:

a) The Staff Support/Backgrounds Unit shall complete a records check on the citizens requesting to ride along. The records check shall consist of: Sarpy County and Douglas County background checks, a state and nation wide warrants check, and a NCIC criminal history check. No person with a prior criminal history (including a conviction for

a serious misdemeanor or felony, or a history of felony arrests) shall be allowed to ride along without special permission granted by the Sheriff.

b) The individual requesting to ride shall list three dates and times they would like to ride.

c) Citizens may ride between 0600 and 2300 hours, unless specifically approved by the Sheriff.

~~d)~~ Citizens shall wear appropriate attire. Citizens shall be advised to wear comfortable, business casual clothing and closed toe/heel-shoes.

e) The Ride Along Request Form must be signed by the Patrol Commander prior to the ride-along.

f) All citizens must sign a Release From Responsibility form prior to riding. If the citizen is under the age of eighteen (18), the Release From Responsibility form must be signed by a parent or legal guardian. No person under the age of sixteen (16) shall be allowed to participate in a ride-along without special permission granted by the Sheriff.

g) The citizen is an observer only and shall not become involved in or interfere with any situation.

h) No recording devices (audio or video) shall be permitted without the specific approval of the Sheriff.

i) All citizens riding in Sarpy County Sheriff's Office vehicles shall follow department policy (see G-4300).

j) When possible, prisoners shall not be transported in vehicles containing citizen observers.

k) Citizens shall not be allowed to leave the patrol unit unless given permission to do so by the deputy.

l) Citizens may request that the ride-along be terminated at any time. The citizen shall be returned to the Sheriff's Office as soon as practical.

m) No ride-along may carry a weapon at any time.

n) Media personnel shall adhere to ride-along procedures.

o) Ride alongs shall not last in excess of four hours, unless approved by the Sheriff.

2. The Division Commander receiving the approved request shall assign a deputy to take the ride-along. If possible, the assigned deputy should be a field-training officer or supervisor.

B. Citizen Ride Alongs-Deputies Responsibilities:

1. The assigned deputy shall contact the citizen and make arrangements to meet the citizen at the Sheriff's Office at the scheduled time.

2. The assigned deputy shall ensure the Release From Responsibility form is completed.

3. The deputy shall notify Communications of the presence of the ride-along.

4. The assigned deputy may terminate the ride-along if the citizen fails to follow regulations or acts in a manner inconsistent with the best interest of the Sheriff's Office.

C. Department Personnel Requests:

1. Sarpy County Sheriff's Office non-sworn personnel (including Sarpy County Communications employees) requests:

a) The non-sworn member shall make a request to ride along to the Road Patrol Division Commander.

b) Road Patrol Commander, upon approval, will assign ride along requests to the appropriate Watch Commander.

c) The watch commander shall assign a field training officer or a supervisor to the ride along.

d) The non-sworn member shall abide by the guidelines for citizen ride alongs (**g-n** above).

2. Sworn Deputies (prior to completion of the Field Training Program): Sworn members who have graduated from the Nebraska Law Enforcement Training Center, but who have not

completed the Field Training Program may request to ride with a field training officer or supervisor under the following conditions.

a) The requesting deputy must schedule the date and time with the appropriate watch commander.

b) The requesting deputy must obtain written permission from the appropriate shift supervisor, the appropriate watch commander, the Road Patrol Commander, and the Sheriff.

c) The deputy shall present the signed written permission to the appropriate shift supervisor at the prearranged time.

d) The deputy shall ride with a field training officer or shift supervisor and shall be under the strict direction and control of that deputy.

e) The requesting deputy shall wear the appropriate Road Patrol uniform and have all appropriate equipment according to policy.

3. **Chaplain:** Deputies may request a chaplain to ride along during their tour of duty, on a short notice basis, with the approval of the shift supervisor or a Road Patrol Commander.